

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a newspaper in Hong Kong:

Li Ka Shing Foundation to give HK\$5,000 each to DSE candidates in remote districts

Gift comes under scheme that covers 3,700 candidates from schools in Tin Shui Wai and outlying islands.

Tycoon Li Ka-shing's charity is giving HK\$5,000 cash each to students in some districts sitting for the Diploma of Secondary Education examination. The Li Ka Shing Foundation said it hoped that the gift would enable them to focus their energy on the exam.

It comes under the pilot scheme "Decide Well, Spend Wisely", which covers 3,700 candidates from secondary schools in Tin Shui Wai and outlying islands, including Lantau, Cheung Chau, Lamma and Peng Chau.

"We trust that [the students] will spend the money wisely according to their needs," the Foundation said in an announcement. Although students will be able to spend the money on anything and there will be no checks, the Foundation is confident that most students will use the money wisely and use it to help their studies and prepare themselves for the exams.

The funds will be distributed upon registration.

The charity explained that the cash initiative was based on feedback received from "Love HK Your Way!", a HK\$300 million charity campaign launched by the foundation in 2010, which indicated unconditional cash distribution could be a direct and cost-efficient approach.

The Foundation said it would review its learning from this pilot scheme and decide whether to extend it to candidates from other areas.

The Foundation was set up in 1980 to manage the tycoon's charitable donations.

The Li Ka Shing Foundation is consulting students about whether the scheme should be available for all students in Hong Kong. They have asked your group for comments on the scheme. You may want to talk about:

- the advantages and disadvantages of the scheme
- whether students will spend the money wisely
- whether it should be available for all students in Hong Kong
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to get this money?
2. Do you think 5000 dollars is too much money to give to students?
3. If you were Li Ka Shing, what charity would you support with the money?
4. Is money important for a successful education?
5. Which other groups of people could benefit more from a donation like this?
6. Are students taught enough about how to manage money?
7. What other kind of help could be given to students?
8. Why do the wealthy like to give money to charity?